

The Spiritual Man and the Spiritual Mind

The Holy Spirit Compares God's Nature With the New Nature in You

We have been examining in some detail what Paul meant when he said the Holy Spirit teaches spiritual things to spiritual by comparing them.

He says He compares spiritual things with spiritual. In that word "comparing," when you compare twins, each one has to have attributes that are alike. Without something alike, there is no comparison.

Paul was saying:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

He is saying that the Holy Ghost teaches by using that language to set up a comparison between the spiritual things of God and spiritual, meaning the part of you that makes you spiritual because you have been born again and received a new nature.

We came into the kingdom of God, translated out of darkness, not knowing everything. But thank God, the day we were born again, we received the fullness of a nature that could be taught and could understand spiritual things.

When you are first born again and receive the Teacher, the Holy Spirit, He compares spiritual things with spiritual. The thing you have that is like God and enables Him to freely make comparisons from one to the other is the new nature you received.

That new nature makes you like God. The best word for it is species. You belong to His species now. You have His nature.

The Duck Knows It Can Swim Because Its Nature Is Not Chicken

If you want to see something funny, slip a duck egg under a chicken sitting on her nest of eggs. Then watch when the old hen goes down by the pond with her brood.

All of a sudden, that little duck breaks and runs for the water. The mother stops him and says, "You are going to drown."

He says, "I am not going to drown. I can swim."

"No, you cannot. You cannot swim. You are a chicken."

He says, "No, I just know I can swim for some reason."

As many times as she tells him he is a chicken, there is something in him that makes him know he can swim. It is his nature. He does not have the nature of a chicken. He has the nature of a duck.

You have been born again. You do not have the nature of the first Adam. You have the nature of the last Adam. Trust me, you can swim.

The Teacher Uses Scripture's Legacy to Take Us Beyond Milk

The third Person of the Godhead has stepped up inside you. He has come to make the comparison, to cause you to understand the Word that has been spoken before you and to understand spiritual things.

He has come to take the legacy of the great men of God who went before us, left behind in the canon of Scripture, and cause you to understand it.

Kenneth Hagin said when he started the Bible college, "You do not have to start all this from the beginning. I had to start this in the beginning of my life. I fully expect you to pick it up where we left off and take it further."

Why reinvent the wheel? Why start with nothing, void of revelation knowledge, and not pay attention to the canon of Scripture? Men gave their whole lives to leave a legacy behind, hoping that once Paul could get you on the foundation he established in Romans, Galatians, First and Second Corinthians, Colossians, and Ephesians, you would understand that foundation.

The great Teacher has come to take everything they said and cause you to understand it, so you can get off milk and have your foundation. Once you have that foundation, you do not have to fall from it.

Whatever your call is, whether apostle, prophet, teacher, pastor, evangelist, the entrepreneurship of the simplicity of giving, the ministry of helps, governments from president to meter maid, all the armies in between to get the job done, all the way to the prayer ministries of the diversities of tongues, the foundation remains the same.

Very little is said about those offices. We try to go to the Old Covenant and look at the prophets there. We try to derive most examples for men who have been born again from underneath the shadow.

But it is another story now. They operated in the shadow of the rebirth. We operate in the new nature itself. There is a difference.

Yet those ministries are lying there, waiting to be fulfilled. Once a man understands they are in the Church and are the foundation of it, those foundational truths God gave are never meant to be varied from. Never.

Apostolic Doctrine Confronts the Bondage of False Teaching

When God takes one of these offices you are called to, who are you left to develop that call?

We are sadly lacking in the mighty apostle's ministry. Contrary to what many believe, most equate the apostolic call only with power. In reality, he has all the callings and giftings working in him. He can go anywhere, do anything, and leave any ministry behind in his wake.

He is also used by God to go into trouble spots, because one of his most powerful callings is doctrine. His most powerful call is doctrine.

That is where the Church is mostly defeated: doctrine.

Once you get a man like Joseph Smith who starts the wheel rolling, you have all the sheep that will follow him. Doctrine is a very powerful tool. Satan loves to form doctrine and religion because there is usually one man faithful to keep people in bondage and train his disciples to keep them in bondage generation after generation.

Once you receive your calling and have the foundational truths given to you by the Word of God, for God's sake, how do you think you are going to get by without prayer? How do you think you will get by without praying these mysteries Paul is talking about?

"Not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

How do you think you are going to get by in your call without using the foundational truths as your standard to grow and live by, and then letting Him separate you to an office people know very little about?

How are you going to do that by sitting under people who say you can pray too much in tongues and get weird? Who do you think they are working for?

Zeal Without Truth Can Beat the Air

There are many people who love God and would do anything for Him. That is why Paul warned against being one who beats the air.

You can be full of energy and willing to do anything for God. You might even establish a monastery and lock people up in it. You might make them take vows of silence.

How much further can you get from:

"Go ye into all the world,
and preach the gospel to every creature.
These signs shall follow them that believe..."

Lock yourself up in a monastery and take vows of silence. You wonder, who got to these men?

If you are real, it takes a lot of energy, consecration, and dedication to lock yourself up in a room and shut your mouth.

You say, "At least they are not talking unbelief."

No, they are not. They are living in the greatest amount of it you can live in.

Satan knows how to handle those who are full of energy. He will get you beating the air. It does not matter how much energy you have; what matters is what you spend it for.

If you took that same amount of consecrated time and began to speak those mysteries, letting the Holy Ghost use a language not taught by man's wisdom to set up a comparison between the spiritual things of God and your new nature, you would need that energy when the devil comes and says, "Another troublemaker."

First, you start looking for legitimate excuses. They are only legitimate for as long as it takes you to change that lifestyle, delegitimize the excuse, and get back into prayer.

"You will have to work two jobs."

Yes, but that is only temporary until His prosperity comes.

Hallelujah.

It starts by grabbing those stolen moments. To accept defeat in that realm is a sad thing.

God Uses Any Truthful Source Because He Wants You to Know

Thank God for the men who went before us. The mighty apostle has more of a doctrinal call than anything. We have recognized this when men pioneered whole areas taken away from the Church, like Smith Wigglesworth, whom they called the apostle of faith, or Luther in the Reformation.

These men got in the way of the Church, got in her path, and said, "This is not right. This is what God said," and turned the tide of history.

You have a new nature, and any way God can get teaching to you, He will get it to you. If God did not want you to know what I know from the Holy Ghost comparing spiritual to spiritual, then what am I doing standing up here?

If He is trying to get into you what He taught me about the Word, which He is, then I am not the only vehicle. If God the third Person came to be your Teacher, this means He is desperate to get this into you.

It does not matter the source. Whether through praying in tongues, through teaching, or through something else, if it is truth, are you able to understand it? Praying in tongues, by this comparison, causes you to begin to understand spiritual things.

That is why the Teacher carries that tool with Him and uses it. It is His power to get our authority to change anything that needs to be changed about us, and that includes filthiness of spirit, which is wrong believing.

If a child rides by on a tricycle and is speaking truth, I can be taught. He wants you to know.

Sometimes people do not have the Holy Spirit, yet they have a new nature and grab hold of certain truths. If it is truth, God is not withholding anything. Just because a man is not in your camp does not mean God is not trying to minister equally to every individual in the entire Body of Christ.

He is no respecter of persons.

If you think anybody has a special call in a way that makes him an exception, there really is no such thing. When Paul talks about being separated, he said God did not make a mistake because:

"I laboured more abundantly than they all:
yet not I,
but the grace of God which was with me."

It was not anything Paul provided. It was something God had already provided that Paul got hold of, and that is where he got the strength to minister more abundantly than they all.

There are no ages in our dispensation. He has called you to do what the early Church did. He gave the same giftings to them as He has to us. Everything He has is available to us.

The devil has just had a little more time to study this creation. He knows what can defeat a person. He knows how to get zealous people to sit in the mountains of Tibet and stare out a little square window, burn a candle, and challenge the world to get them now.

He knows how to get a man of great energy to spend it doing nothing, to beat the air where it makes no difference.

What he is most afraid of is you who do not beat the air, who spend every moment of that energy doing what produces the change from glory to glory.

Hallelujah.

Peace Is the Atmosphere of Living in Him

I love being called, and I love being in the ministry. At times people ask me, "How do you stand up under that stuff?"

I say, "I occupy my two-by-two-foot cubicle. Wherever I am, I bring it with me. I live in it. I live in peace. I carry it with me. I change the atmosphere wherever I go. And if they threaten me, I will let that atmosphere out of that cubicle."

There is peace in it. Hallelujah. There is peace in it.

Why would you walk into anything else?

Torment and fear are the absence of that love. God does not just have love; He is love. I have Him.

Jesus said:

"In the world ye shall have tribulation:
but be of good cheer;
I have overcome the world."

You are in Me. I am in Him. He is in me. I am in this world. So what is the difference? The world has tribulation; I do not. In the world I will have tribulation because that tribulation is around me in the world, but I am of good cheer because in Him I have peace, and we have overcome the world.

Why would a man tear his body up worrying? Why burn the ends of your hair off because your brain is putting out so much energy worrying? Some of your hair even dies, has a funeral, and waves goodbye at each other.

Why would you do that to your body?

"I cannot help it."

He has a lot of instruction in there about how to help it. So why would you stay not helping it?

"It is just the way I am."

Is that some catch-all statement for not changing?

"It is a cultural thing."

Yes, until you met Jesus. Then you became a new creation.

Peace is wonderful. Sometimes I feel guilty because when people are screaming and going down in great arrays of defeat, I do not want to go with them. Sometimes it is hard to feel sorry for them. You can have compassion, but that is different from the limitations of natural love.

With compassion, if you could take their place, you would, because you know that if you could change places with them, you could turn it. You wonder, "Why are they going there? Why do they not believe what the Word says?"

Sometimes I have to go back to where He brought me from and remember a little bit of those feelings before they died, before they were pushed out, transformed by the renewing of the mind. I have to remember how those feelings felt when I am watching someone fly apart like a cheap clock, springs flying everywhere, going to pieces right in front of me.

Then I remember it was a process. You just have to keep them doing the right thing. It is a process of transformation by the renewing of the mind, to prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God.

The same way He reveals His perfect will in my life in the call is the same way He transforms me out of torments and fears and reveals peace in me.

But if I am not walking toward one, I am not walking toward the other. It is hard for Him to reveal absolute peace in you without revealing His plan for your life, because it is impossible to walk in the fullness of His peace while saying, "I am going to do what I want."

Excuses Are Built to Resist a Present Truth

I love peace. Glory be to God, I love it.

When God is love, the first thing that love manifests is freedom from torment and fear. I can understand that, because that is confidence in God in every area, from strife, hatred, and emulations with your neighbors all the way to not being able to believe Him because you are void of the Word.

Most teachings keep us in an area where that kind of peace is almost impossible because they do not let us know God enough.

But my experience with God has been that every time I tried to use an excuse, I saw Him standing there pointing to the Word of God.

If you think about it, the only reason most of us have excuses is that an excuse is something needed to excuse you from a present truth. You usually point at an excuse because you understand the Word says you are free.

"I need one."

Of course you do.

Our old mind locks up when we hear truth. It absolutely locks up when people teach how free we are and then hit some area where we are not free. Then the old justification starts rolling out.

"I have a reason. I have a reason."

The only reason you really have is that, as of yet, the Word has not finished transforming you in that operation. That would be the problem I would work on.

People's solutions are okay, but most of them are temporary. God's solutions are permanent.

The only things I am still locked in are the things I did not yet know how to come out of. Every time I learn how to come out, the thing to do is obey, renew myself, and strengthen myself until I come out of those areas.

Hallelujah.

Sometimes when you counsel people, you need to say, "Did you do what I told you last time?"

"No."

"Okay, session is over. What are you waiting for me to tell you? Something you want to do? Something that agrees with your theology? If that were the case, you would already be free."

One woman said, "I am going to go check myself into the institution."

I said, "Go ahead. What is your normal stay? Three months? Then you will come back and lean against the same wall and ask me the same questions, and I will tell you to do the same thing. Why not save yourself a trip?"

Donna was sitting in, learning some of the counseling. She watched me bring one woman back to the answer, the watering trough, forty times in an hour. That is about one and a half times a minute.

"Yes, but the Word says this."

"I know all of that, but you do not understand what my problem is. They did this and they did that."

"I know all that, but the Word says..."

As you hold the truth up, you do not have much hope of getting out of anything if you refuse it.

"I have been set free two or three times, and it came back."

Being delivered at the hands of somebody else usually is not the permanent answer. Being delivered by His hands always is. If I can get Him to come and heal me, then I know exactly how I got it. If I know how I got it, I know how to hang on to it.

If I did not know how I got it from your hands, I thank God for it. It is great. But the devil may pull the same thing he did the first time when he put it on me. So my desire before my grace period runs out is to find out how to live in the presence of Him who said I was healed.

Hallelujah.

First Corinthians 2 Reveals the Teaching Process Again

The foundation He has given us about His deliverance in the cross is so important. Let us back up and scan this again as we look deeper at the mystery He is trying to reveal in each of us.

First Corinthians 2:6 says:

"Howbeit we speak wisdom
among them that are perfect:
yet not the wisdom of this world,
nor of the princes of this world,
that come to nought."

The wisdom of the world comes and goes. It dies and lives with cultures. It means nothing to eternity.

But Paul says:

"We speak the wisdom of God
in a mystery,
even the hidden wisdom,
which God ordained before the world
unto our glory."

At one time this wisdom was hidden on the other side of spiritual death. But these apostles went into God and pulled the wisdom that was in that mystery out, and now Paul ministers it to the Church.

Verse 8 says:

"Which none of the princes of this world knew:
for had they known it,
they would not have crucified
the Lord of glory."

Then verse 9:

"Eye hath not seen,
nor ear heard,
neither have entered into the heart of man,
the things which God hath prepared
for them that love him."

It had not entered into the spiritually dead heart of man. But thank God, between verses 9 and 10 we got born again:

"But God hath revealed them unto us
by his Spirit:
for the Spirit searcheth all things,
yea, the deep things of God."

Now it is our new nature that has the capacity to search the things of God, yes, the deep things.

Verse 11 says:

"For what man knoweth the things of a man,
save the spirit of man
which is in him?
even so the things of God
knoweth no man,
but the Spirit of God."

What man knows the things of a man except that unregenerated spiritually dead spirit in him? He could not know anything outside the death nature. Even so, the things of God no man knows except by that new nature in him, and now he can explore everything God is.

Verse 12 says:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

We did not receive the spirit of the world, the one Adam gave us, the death we inherited from him. We received the spirit which is of God, little "s," that we might know by that new nature the things freely given to us by God.

Verse 13 says:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words
which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things
with spiritual."

He uses that supernatural language to compare the spiritual things of God, those mysteries, to the part of you that has been born again and has the nature that can understand what He is trying to teach you.

Then Paul switches back to spiritual death in verse 14:

"But the natural man receiveth not
the things of the Spirit of God:
for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them,
because they are spiritually discerned."

The natural man's mind is under subjection to spiritual death and cannot understand them.

Verse 15 says:

"But he that is spiritual
judgeth all things,
yet he himself is judged of no man."

The things he judges by are that world of the Spirit and that operation of the Holy Spirit. Yet he himself is judged of no man because the natural man and the kingdoms that come and go do not have access to that same discerning process. They have no way of knowing or judging it.

Then verse 16 says:

"For who hath known the mind of the Lord,
that he may instruct him?
But we have the mind of Christ."

The Mind of Christ Is Standard Equipment in the New Creation

This mind of Christ is part of the standard equipment of the new creation. The same way I received this new nature, I also received a spiritual mind that is the same kind Jesus had in His spirit and nature when, as the Father had life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself.

Jesus, the spiritual Man, had quite a spiritual mind. Now you have that same kind as standard equipment in your new creation.

In that verse, Paul does not mean that you in your spirit automatically have everything in Christ's mind in your mind. That is why He sent you the Holy Spirit.

The Holy Spirit carries the mind of Christ and is able to transfer the mind of Christ into your mind. That is the process Paul was talking about.

Romans 8:26-27 says:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities:
for we know not what we should pray for as we ought:
but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us
with groanings which cannot be uttered.
And he that searcheth the hearts
knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit,
because he maketh intercession for the saints
according to the will of God."

He who searches the heart knows what is the mind of the Spirit, or the mind of Christ, the mind that is in God, and makes intercession for you according to that mind.

In that intercession is the plan of God. It is all those mysteries you are praying in that supernatural language that compares the spiritual things of God to the mind of Christ that is standard equipment in your new creation.

You have a spiritual mind just like the one Jesus had when He was born on this earth, the first man to be born spiritually alive in four thousand years.

That is part of your standard equipment. You have a nature. A nature is not your intellect, will, or emotion. It is a nature that makes the duck know it can swim. You also now have a spiritual mind with capacity to understand, discern, equip, and know.

It is an incredible adventure. You might as well get ready. You are a new species. You are a new creation.

Hallelujah.

The Old Mind Must Be Retought by the New Teacher

Does He have a job getting this into us? Oh, yes.

The worst thing I hate about this walk is carrying that natural mind around with me, programmed by the world. My old brain and soul were thoroughly programmed, thoroughly taught by the world and by the sin nature. That is the only teaching I knew for twenty years: the teaching the sin nature gave me.

All of a sudden, I got born again and had a new Teacher.

My old teacher taught me well because I had the nature to be taught. He taught me well. But now I have a new Teacher, and I understand there is a new way to do things.

Hallelujah.

I already know I can swim, so I am jumping in the water. If I am a goldfish, I have a lot of teeth.

Hello, piranha. Hallelujah.

Somebody gave me a picture of a goldfish with a little baby piranha in front of it. You should have seen the teeth on that piranha.

Glory to God.

There is a mystery. It is the mystery of Christ He is trying to get over to you. He wants you to understand.

Even after all the apostles and everything they wrote, their foundational truth can be discerned and received by our spiritual mind. That spiritual mind can understand the things your nature can operate in.

We have all that going for us, plus a Teacher who has gained authority in our lives by borrowing our positional truth from us to pray out of, which is the new creation.

If I pray in an unknown tongue, my human spirit prays. The Teacher is borrowing our authority so He can pray the mystery of everything Christ is in us, to us, and through us, the hope of glory, against the day when our old soul is so transformed that it is not working against us anymore but working for us.

He is praying toward the day when that nature that tells us we can swim can swim out in the midst of a hundred wheelchairs and know that it can swim.

Colossians Reveals the Mystery the Spirit Wants to Form in Us

Who is He trying to reveal in us?

If you begin to understand what He is trying to get over to you, I doubt you will ever stop praying in tongues again. I doubt the devil will be able to put it subliminally on the back burner so far that you start calling us names.

Go to Colossians 1.

My God, what is wrong with prayer? We encourage people to pray, and they disintegrate because their weaknesses take them over again when it is time to face them. Who are you going to blame? If you are going to get out from under the teaching, you have to be right somehow, so who is convenient to blame?

I do not mind. I read about Paul. The Holy Ghost tried to warn him about eight hundred times that he was going to be brought under the wrong kind of bondage. When he got into Jerusalem, what did he do? He took vows of purification. If you are going to beat me up, I would rather it be for the right cause.

James hoped that if Paul took the vow of purification, the Jews would leave him alone. But they did not. They broke into the temple before the vows were even over. What would have made me mad is that I would have shaved my head for nothing.

Colossians 1:12 says:

"Giving thanks unto the Father,
which hath made us meet
to be partakers of the inheritance
of the saints in light."

Giving thanks to the Father for His role in all this, as we give thanks to the Son for His role as humanity and deity. The Father has made us meet, or able, to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light.

The inheritance. Hallelujah. I guess I am no more a bondservant, am I?

Verse 13 says:

"Who hath delivered us
from the power of darkness,
and hath translated us
into the kingdom of his dear Son:
in whom we have redemption
through his blood,
even the forgiveness of sins."

Christ Is Firstborn of Creation and Firstborn From the Dead

Colossians 1:15 says:

"Who is the image of the invisible God,
the firstborn of every creature."

In this role, He is likened to the image of the invisible God, which He is and we are.

He is the image of the invisible God for this role: the firstborn of every creature.

Verse 16 begins with "for," a conjunction tying two thoughts together. What he is about to say is based on what he has already said, so the understanding of verse 15 is in verse 16:

"For by him were all things created,
that are in heaven,
and that are in earth,
visible and invisible,
whether they be thrones,
or dominions,
or principalities,
or powers:
all things were created by him,
and for him."

When Paul says He is the firstborn of every creature, he is not talking there about Him as the Head of the Church, the firstborn of the new creation, that in all things He might have preeminence. He is talking about Him as Creator, the firstborn of everything created.

If you want to know who was actually doing the work in Genesis, it was Him.

Hebrews says that in times past God spoke to us by the prophets and fathers, but in these last days He has spoken to us by His Son, by whom also He made the worlds.

John 1 says:

"In the beginning was the Word,
and the Word was with God,
and the Word was God.
The same was in the beginning with God.
All things were made by him;
and without him was not any thing made
that was made."

In the beginning, before anything in creation had a beginning, God existed forever as the three-in-one eternal Godhead. There was no time when they did not exist. I know you cannot understand time without time. They were always there.

What we understand in creation had a beginning, and that is the only beginning He talks about in Genesis and in John 1.

Genesis says:

"In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth."

Three Persons of the Godhead took their roles and created everything that is. John explains the role of the Creator. In the beginning was the Word, the Logos. He was with God. He was God. He was in the beginning face to face with the other two members of the Godhead.

Then John isolates the Word, Jesus, as Creator:

"All things were made by him;
and without him was not any thing made
that was made."

There is only one thing in all creation that came from the Father, and that was when Jesus' own human spirit was born. As the Father had life in Himself, He gave to the Son, to the humanity of the mighty Logos, to have life in Himself.

Hallelujah.

Everything else: He is the firstborn of every creature. It was from Him the first two whales came. And that is the whale of the truth. The first two gazelles. The first creation of everything came from Him.

He is the image of the invisible God. He is God, in God's image. He is Man, in our image. He is the firstborn of everything that has been created.

Verse 17 says:

"And he is before all things,
and by him all things consist."

Verse 18 says:

"And he is the head of the body,
the church:
who is the beginning,
the firstborn from the dead;
that in all things
he might have the preeminence."

Now Paul is speaking of Him concerning the Church, the new creation. He is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things He might have preeminence.

It is this Man, this God-Man, that the Holy Ghost is trying to reveal in you through those mysteries.

He is the firstborn from the dead. Since the fall of Adam and the inheritance of spiritual death by the whole human race from that first man, not one man had been born out of that spiritual death. Not one.

How do you know? Because Jesus is the firstborn from the dead.

Yes, there were resurrections in the Old Testament. Those were resurrections of the body. The spirit was put back in the body with the remnant. But Jesus is the firstborn from the dead, that He might have preeminence.

Not one man had been born from spiritual death since the death of Adam and the inheritance of that death by the human race. Jesus is the firstborn.

Hallelujah.

That is why John says:

"As the Father raiseth up the dead,
and quickeneth..."

There was no "them" there. The King James translators were trying to help you understand. The verse says that as the Father raises up the dead and makes alive, then the Son turns around and quickens whom He will.

Jesus is the firstborn of everything created, and in this new creation He Himself became the firstborn from the dead. You followed.

I do not know how far down the list I am, but I know the same thing that happened in Him happened in me. Part of my standard equipment now is the mind that is in Him. It is in me. The Teacher who was in Him is in me.

Glory be to God forever.

The Hidden Mystery Is Christ in You, the Hope of Glory

Colossians 1:19 says:

"For it pleased the Father
that in him should all fulness dwell."

Verse 20:

"And, having made peace
through the blood of his cross,
by him to reconcile all things
unto himself;
by him, I say,
whether they be things in earth,
or things in heaven."

Then:

"And you,
that were sometime alienated
and enemies in your mind
by wicked works,
yet now hath he reconciled
in the body of his flesh
through death,
to present you holy
and unblameable
and unreprouable
in his sight:
if ye continue in the faith
grounded and settled,
and be not moved away
from the hope of the gospel."

Paul says he was made a minister:

"Who now rejoice in my sufferings for you,
and fill up that which is behind
of the afflictions of Christ
in my flesh
for his body's sake,
which is the church:
whereof I am made a minister,
according to the dispensation of God
which is given to me for you,
to fulfil the word of God;
even the mystery
which hath been hid
from ages
and from generations,
but now is made manifest
to his saints."

That mystery has been hidden from ages and generations, but now it has been revealed to His saints:

"To whom God would make known
what is the riches of the glory
of this mystery among the Gentiles;
which is Christ in you,
the hope of glory."

In a language the world did not know, not in the language man's wisdom teaches, but in the language the Holy Ghost teaches, using that supernatural medium to compare spiritual things with spiritual, He wants us to understand the mystery hidden from ages but now revealed to the great Church of God: the mystery of everything Christ is in you, the hope of glory.

Paul's Sufferings Filled Up What Still Lived in His Flesh

Paul said he was filling up in his flesh what was behind of the afflictions of Christ for His body's sake, which is the Church. Nobody preaches on that verse because they do not know what it means.

What he was actually talking about is this: he did not care what kind of sufferings befell him, and at the time he wrote this epistle, he was in prison. He says, "Meanwhile, there is being filled up in me of the sufferings of Christ, that which still lacks in my flesh."

He said, "I can tell you why. It is for the Body of Christ, for the body's sake, which is the Body of Christ."

Everything in my flesh that Jesus suffered and died for, and yet is still alive, Paul says, "Fill it up with Your sufferings, Jesus. Fill it up for the body's sake, so I will be counted worthy to minister to them, fully equipped and qualified."

He was.

Does it make you want to pray in tongues?

It is this Man, this God-Man, the mighty Word by whom all things were created, that the Holy Ghost is trying to reveal in you.

The substance for the chair you are sitting on came from which Person of the Godhead? Him, the deity of Jesus. All substance came from His Person. Through Him, thrones, dominions, and invisible things belonging to another world, such as angels, were created. The substance and consistency of what things consist of came from His individual being.

The worlds, universes, and vastness of God seen in creation came from the second Person. He became this Man whose spirit was born from the Father, so He would become the firstborn of this creation also, and could be the Head of your creation.

In all things He has preeminence and authority as the Head of the Church, to be revealed and to become everything He said He is and will be, as revealed by the Holy Spirit in you.

So for God's sake, the Holy Ghost wants to pray to reveal Him in you.

Turn Him loose.